

Fix Your Credit Score - Printable Worksheets and Letters

From *Fix Your Credit Score* by Thomas Ashcroft (Oro Enigma Publishing). Print and adapt as many copies as you need.

Worksheet 1 - The report review (one per bureau)

Bureau and date pulled	
Personal information errors (names, addresses, employers not mine)	
Accounts: not mine	
Accounts: wrong balance, limit, status or dates	
Accounts: late payments I dispute (with the evidence I have)	
Collections: not mine / duplicate / medical under \$500 or paid / older than 7 years /	

re-aged	
Public records other than a bankruptcy	
Inquiries I do not recognise	
Items that are mine and negative (for Chapters 7 and 8)	
Items that should have dropped off (date of first delinquency + 7 years)	
Disputes to send (bureau / furnisher / date sent / result due)	

Worksheet 2 - The scores over time

Date	Source (bank / app / lender)	Model (FICO 8, Vantage 3...)	Score	What changed since last time

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Worksheet 3 - Utilisation

Card	Limit	Statement closing date	Balance now	Utilisation (balance / limit)	Target balance for 30%	Target for 10%	Pay by (date)
All cards							

Worksheet 4 - The debt list and payoff plan

Debt	Balance	Rate	Minimum	Order (avalanche: highest rate first; snowball: smallest balance first)	Extra this month	Paid off (date)

Totals						

Worksheet 5 - Collections and old debts

Collector	Original creditor	Amount	Date of first delinquency	Drops off (DO FD + 7 years)	Statute of limitations runs out (state)	Validation letter sent	Validated?	Decision (pay in full / settle / pay-for-delete / leave)	Agreement in writing?

Worksheet 6 - The dispute log

Item	Bureau / furnisher	Sent (certified no.)	Evidence enclosed	Due (30 / 45 days)	Result	Next step (re-dispute / method of verification / CFPB / lawyer)

Worksheet 7 - The 90-day plan

Task	Done (date)
Days 1 to 7: three reports pulled and reviewed; score recorded; autopay on everything; freezes placed; debt list and utilisation done	
Days 8 to 30: disputes mailed	

(bureaus and furnishers); validation letters; cards paid below 30% then 10%; limit increases asked; past-dues brought current; goodwill and pay-for-delete letters; authorised user / rent reporting / secured card; debt plan chosen and started	
Days 31 to 60: dispute results; re- disputes and method-of- verification requests; CFPB complaints; balances checked; second goodwill letters; no new applications	
Days 61 to 90: corrected reports pulled; score recorded next to day 1; debt plan third payment; next 90- day date set	

Template 1 - Dispute letter to a credit bureau

[Your name, address, date of birth, last four digits of Social Security number]

[Date]

[Bureau dispute address: Equifax, P.O. Box 740256, Atlanta, GA 30374 / Experian, P.O. Box 4500, Allen, TX 75013 / TransUnion, P.O. Box 2000, Chester, PA 19016; check the current address on each site]

Re: Dispute of inaccurate information; report number [from the report]

I am writing to dispute the following information on my credit report, under my rights in the Fair Credit Reporting Act, section 611.

Item 1: [Creditor name, account number as shown]. The report shows [what it shows]. This is inaccurate because [the fact]. Enclosed is [the evidence]. Please [correct it to / delete it].

Item 2: [as above]

Please investigate, correct or delete the items above, send me the results in writing with a free copy of my corrected report, and tell me the name and address of any furnisher you contacted. I have enclosed a copy of my report with the items circled, a copy of my identification, and the evidence listed.

Sincerely,

[Signature; name]

Enclosures: [list]

Template 2 - Dispute letter to a furnisher (creditor or collector)

[Your name, address; the account number]

[Date]

[Furnisher's address for disputes, from its statement or website]

Re: Notice of dispute of inaccurate credit reporting; account
[number]

You are reporting to [bureau(s)] that [what is reported]. This is inaccurate because [the fact]; enclosed is [the evidence]. Under the Fair Credit Reporting Act, section 623, you must investigate this dispute, correct any inaccurate information you have reported, and notify each bureau of the correction. Please confirm in writing within 30 days what you have done.

Sincerely,

[Signature; name]

Template 3 - Debt validation request to a collector (within 30 days of their first notice)

[Your name, address]

[Date]

[Collector's address; the reference number from their letter]

Re: Your letter dated [date]; reference [number]

I am requesting validation of this debt under the Fair Debt Collection Practices Act, section 809. Please provide: the amount of the debt and how it was calculated; the name and address of the original creditor; a copy of the original signed agreement or statements showing the debt is mine; the date of first delinquency; and evidence that you own the debt or are authorised to collect it in my state, including your licence number if my state requires one.

Until you have provided this, please cease collection activity and do not report this debt to any credit bureau as undisputed. This letter is not an acknowledgement that I owe this debt. Please communicate with me in writing only.

Sincerely,

[Signature; name]

Template 4 - Pay-for-delete offer

[Your name, address]

[Date]

[Collector's address; reference number]

Re: Account [number]; settlement offer conditional on deletion

I am prepared to pay \$[amount] in full settlement of the above account, on the condition that you agree in writing, before payment, to delete the account entirely from my credit reports at Equifax, Experian and TransUnion within 30 days of receiving payment, and not to sell, transfer or re-report the balance. This letter is not an acknowledgement of the debt and does not restart any statute of limitations. If you accept, please send a signed letter on your letterhead confirming these terms, and I will pay by [cashier's cheque / traceable method] within 10 days of receiving it.

Sincerely,

[Signature; name]

Template 5 - Goodwill letter to a creditor

[Your name, address; the account number]

[Date]

[Creditor's customer-care or executive-office address]

Re: Request for goodwill adjustment; account [number]

I have been a customer since [year] and have paid this account on time every month except [month/year], when [the circumstance, briefly: I was in hospital / my father died / my employer's payroll failed / the bank's autopay did not run]. I brought the account current on [date] and it has been paid on time since. I am asking, as a goodwill gesture, whether you would remove the [30-day] late payment reported for [month/year] from my credit reports. It does not reflect how I have handled this account, and it is affecting [a mortgage application / a rental application]. Thank you for considering this.

Sincerely,

[Signature; name]

